PERSONAL LICENCE / PRACTICE EXAM

40 original questions | Answer 1 choice per question | Suggested target: 28/40. Not an accredited examination.

01. How many statutory licensing objectives are there?

A. Two
B. Three
C. Four
D. Five

02. Which is a licensing objective?

A. Maximising alcohol revenue
B. Prevention of public nuisance
C. Reducing all business rates
D. Promoting tourism

03. Which is normally a licensable activity?

A. Selling packaged alcohol by retail
B. Selling soft drinks at 3pm
C. Serving cold sandwiches
D. Providing Wi-Fi

04. Who usually grants a premises licence?

A. The venue bartender
B. The local licensing authority
C. The landlord alone
D. An awarding body

05. A personal licence alone allows sales of alcohol:

A. Anywhere at any hour
B. Only when required premises authority exists
C. Without following any conditions
D. Only inside the holder's home

06. What does DPS stand for?

A. Daily Police Supervisor
B. Designated Premises Supervisor
C. Director of Public Safety
D. Designated Promotions Seller

07. How many DPSs can normally be named on a premises licence at one time?

A. One
B. Two
C. Five
D. Unlimited

08. Must the DPS personally pour every alcoholic drink?

A. Yes
B. No, suitably authorised staff can sell
C. Only at weekends
D. Only if wine is sold

09. Is written authorisation to sell alcohol expressly required by the Licensing Act 2003?

A. Always
B. Never possible
C. Not expressly required, but strongly recommended
D. Only for table service

10. The normal minimum age to apply for a personal licence is:

A. 16
B. 17
C. 18
D. 21

11. Passing APLH on its own makes a learner a personal licence holder:

A. True
B. False
C. Only on weekends
D. Only on licensed premises

12. An applicant normally needs which qualification?

A. An approved licensing qualification
B. A driving test
C. A security badge
D. A hygiene score

13. Personal licences currently:

A. Require annual renewal
B. Last 12 months
C. Generally do not require periodic renewal
D. Automatically cover every venue

14. For retail alcohol sales, customers normally must be at least:

A. 16
B. 17
C. 18
D. 20

15. Challenge 25 is:

A. The statutory legal minimum for any alcohol sale
B. A commonly used venue age-checking policy
C. A licence fee
D. A type of TEN

16. A qualifying physical ID should include:

A. Name only
B. Photo and birth date plus recognised security feature
C. Home address only
D. School uniform

17. A digital ID photo shown on a phone, by itself, is:

A. Automatically sufficient
B. An accredited APLH certificate
C. Not a compliant registered DVS check
D. Mandatory for all venues

18. Since September 2026, qualifying digital age verification is:

A. Mandatory for all premises
B. An optional route subject to safeguards
C. Forbidden
D. Only for nightclubs

19. Can a 17-year-old buy beer in a pub when with a parent?

A. Yes in all circumstances
B. No, purchase is still prohibited
C. Yes after 10pm
D. Yes if the parent signs a waiver

20. Which circumstance can permit a 16- or 17-year-old to consume beer?

A. Any private party
B. With a table meal accompanied by an adult
C. At any restaurant after midnight
D. With a fake ID

21. What should staff do when unsure if a customer is old enough?

A. Ignore it
B. Serve quickly
C. Apply ID policy and refuse without sufficient proof
D. Ask another guest to vouch

22. Free potable tap water should generally be:

A. Never supplied
B. Available on request where reasonably available
C. Only available with a food purchase
D. Only served after midnight

23. What is the specified small measure for still wine by the glass?

A. 75 ml
B. 100 ml
C. 125 ml
D. 300 ml

24. Which is a specified small beer/cider measure?

A. 1/4 pint
B. 1/2 pint
C. 2 pints
D. 1 litre

25. For gin, rum, vodka and whisky the small option includes:

A. 25ml or 35ml as applicable
B. Only 100ml
C. One whole bottle
D. Unlimited pours

26. Irresponsible promotions are:

A. Always required
B. Restricted by mandatory conditions
C. Only restricted for beer
D. Excluded from all licensing rules

27. Selling alcohol below the permitted price based on duty and VAT is:

A. Required
B. Prohibited
C. Allowed whenever busy
D. Required for private hire

28. Knowingly selling alcohol to someone who is drunk is:

A. Lawful
B. An alcohol-related offence
C. Compulsory
D. Only unlawful at 2 am

29. A guest list removes the need for legal age checks:

A. Yes
B. No
C. For VIP bookings only
D. For birthdays only

30. A key duty when a guest becomes aggressive is to:

A. Continue shots service
B. Ignore warning signs
C. De-escalate and protect safety
D. Lock all emergency exits

31. A TEN event can have how many people at a time including staff?

A. Fewer than 500
B. 700
C. 1000
D. Any number

32. The maximum duration of a single TEN event is:

A. 12 hours
B. 48 hours
C. 168 hours
D. 30 days

33. A personal licence holder can generally give up to how many TENs per year?

A. 5
B. 15
C. 50
D. 100

34. A person without a personal licence can generally give up to how many TENs per year?

A. 2
B. 5
C. 20
D. 50

35. A premises can generally be the subject of up to how many TENs per year?

A. 5
B. 10
C. 15
D. 60

36. What is generally the deadline for a standard TEN?

A. 1 hour
B. At least 10 clear working days
C. Whenever doors open
D. After the event

37. A private members' label automatically exempts a bar from ordinary licensing?

A. Yes
B. No
C. Only in Soho
D. Only on Saturday

38. The DPS must legally remain inside the venue every minute alcohol is sold:

A. Yes
B. No
C. Only if there are fewer than 20 people
D. Only when cocktails are served

39. A useful good-practice record after refusing alcohol service is:

A. A refusal/incident log
B. A cocktail photo
C. A staff playlist
D. A booking advert

40. Which source should staff check for local venue-specific conditions?

A. A competitor Instagram post
B. The actual premises licence and approved plan
C. A customer review
D. The menu alone

ANSWER KEY

01. C The Licensing Act 2003 sets out four objectives.
02. B Preventing public nuisance is one of the four objectives.
03. A Retail alcohol sale is a licensable activity.
04. B The council licensing authority normally determines premises licences.
05. B A personal licence does not itself license a location.
06. B The DPS is the designated premises supervisor.
07. A A premises licence normally specifies a single DPS.
08. B Personal licence holders can authorise alcohol sales by others.
09. C The current statutory guidance recommends written authorisation but says the Act does not mandate it.
10. C Applicants must generally be 18 or over.
11. B The council must grant the individual personal licence.
12. A An approved qualification is normally required.
13. C Periodic renewal was removed in 2015.
14. C Alcohol sales to people under 18 are generally prohibited.
15. B Challenge 25 is a venue policy, not the legal drinking age.
16. B The statutory condition refers to a photo, DOB and hologram/UV feature.
17. C Digital proof has specific registered/certified verification requirements.
18. B Eligible DVS checks may be chosen by the premises.
19. B The table-meal exception concerns consumption, not buying.
20. B The narrow meal exception applies to beer, wine or cider with an adult.
21. C Refuse unless age can be verified under the applicable policy.
22. B A mandatory licensing condition concerns potable water.
23. C 125 ml is the specified small wine measure.
24. B Half a pint is a specified smaller measure.
25. A The condition specifies 25ml or 35ml according to the premises measure.
26. B Certain promotions encouraging excessive or irresponsible drinking are prohibited.
27. B Mandatory conditions prohibit sales below duty plus VAT.
28. B Knowingly selling to a drunk person is unlawful.
29. B Bookings and guest lists do not bypass alcohol age checks.
30. C Safety, refusal, support and escalation are important.
31. A The statutory TEN threshold is fewer than 500.
32. C A TEN event may last at most 168 hours.
33. C Subject to relevant caps and exceptions, personal licence holders have a 50 limit.
34. B Generally five TENs in a calendar year.
35. C The general site limit is 15, with an aggregate day limit too.
36. B Standard TENs normally need 10 clear working days.
37. B The club must satisfy statutory criteria and hold appropriate authorisation.
38. B The DPS need not be physically present at all times.

39. A Accurate contemporaneous records help evidence responsible practice.

40. B The current premises licence and approved plan control venue-specific restrictions.